

Guideline Title: Trauma Alert Criteria

Guideline Number: GUID-3203-T018

Issue date: 09/09/2014	Replaces Dept. Policy:
Revision dates: 07/01/2026	Developed by: Air Care Team
Approved by: Dr. Danielle DiCesare, MD Air Care Team Medical Director	Approved by:
Signature: 	Signature:
Department Numbers: 3203	

- I. **PURPOSE:** To provide rapid, efficient, and coordinated care and transport of the severely injured trauma patient to a State Approved Trauma Center. A Trauma Alert will be activated upon notification from EMS, Hospital, or Flight or Ground Crew Providers.
- II. **PATHOPHYSIOLOGY:** N/A
- III. **DEFINITIONS:**

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IV. DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:

- a. For Adult Patients (16 years old or above), consider the following Trauma Alert Criteria. If met, patients must be called a Trauma Alert and transported to a State Approved Trauma Center.
 - i. The presence of any of the 3 listed items below requires Trauma Alert Activation
 1. Meets color coded triage system (one RED or two BLUE criteria)
 2. GCS $\leq$ 12 (GCS is a stand-alone criterion, even if color coded criteria are not met)
 3. Patient does not meet any of the above criteria, but a Trauma Alert is activated based on Paramedic Discretion. Documentation of reasoning to be included in the patient's EMS chart.

Component	RED Criteria	BLUE Criteria
Airway	Active airway assistance ¹	Respiratory rate $\geq$ 30 breaths/min
Circulation	Any of the following: - Lack of radial pulse with sustained heart rate $\geq$ 120 bpm - Blood pressure < 90 mmHg	Sustained heart rate $\geq$ 120 bpm
Best Motor Response (Glasgow Coma Scale)	Any of the following: - BMR $\leq$ 4 - Suspicion of spinal cord injury -Paralysis -Loss of sensation	BMR $\leq$ 5
Cutaneous	Any of the following: 2° or 3° burns >15% TBSA - Amputation proximal to wrist or ankle - Penetrating injury to head, neck, or torso²	Any of the following: - Soft tissue loss³ - GSW to extremity
Long Bone Fracture	Fracture of 2 or more long bones ⁴	Any of the following: - Single fracture site due to MVC - Fall from $\geq$ 10 feet
Age	N/A	55 years or older
Mechanism of Injury	N/A	Any of the following: - Ejection from a vehicle⁵ - Deformed steering wheel⁶

¹ Airway assistance beyond administration of oxygen

² Excluding superficial wounds in which the depth of the wound can be determined

³ Major degloving injuries or major flap avulsion (>5 inches)

⁴ Longbones include humerus, radius+ulna, femur, tibia+fibia

⁵ Excluding motorcycle, moped, all-terrain vehicle, bicycle, or open body of a pickup truck

⁶ Only applies to driver of vehicle

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- b. For Pediatric Patients (considered 15 years old or younger), consider the following Trauma Alert Criteria. If met, patients must be called a Trauma Alert and transported to a State Approved Pediatric Trauma Center.
- i. The presence of any of the 2 listed items below requires Trauma Alert Activation
 1. Meets color coded triage system (any one RED or two BLUE criteria)
 2. Patient does not meet any of the above criteria, but a Trauma Alert is activated based upon Paramedic Discretion. Documentation of reasoning to be included in the patient's EMS chart.

Component	RED Criteria	BLUE Criteria
Size	N/A	Any of the following: - Weight ≤ 10 kg - Length ≤ 33" (Broselow Red or Purple)
Airway	Assisted Ventilation or Intubated ⁷	N/A
Consciousness	Any of the following: - Altered mental status⁸ - Coma - Suspicion of spinal cord injury; Paralysis or Loss of Sensation	Any of the following: - Amnesia - Loss of Consciousness
Circulation	Any of the following: - Faint or non-palpable carotid or femoral pulse - SBP < 50 mmHg	Any of the following: - Palpable carotid or femoral pulse, but absent radial or pedal pulse - SBP < 90 mmHg - Capillary refill > 3 seconds
Fracture	Any of the following: - Open long bone fracture - Multiple fracture sites⁹ - Multiple dislocations	Single closed long bone fracture
Cutaneous	Any of the following: - Major soft tissue disruption or flap avulsion¹⁰ 2° or 3° burn ≥ 10% TBSA - Amputation¹¹ - Penetrating injury to Head, Neck, or Torso¹²	N/A

⁷ Includes jaw thrust, frequent suctioning, or other airway adjuncts

⁸ Includes drowsiness, lethargy, inability to follow commands, unresponsiveness

⁹ Includes humerus, radius+ulna, femur, tibia+fibia; does not include isolated wrist/ankle fractures

¹⁰ Major degloving injuries

¹¹ Amputations proximal to wrist or ankle

¹² Excluding superficial wounds where depth can be accurately determined

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- c. State Approved Trauma Centers are listed below

FLORIDA TRAUMA CENTERS		
Updated June 27, 2025		
Trauma Center	Level	County
Ascension Sacred Heart Bay	Level II	Bay
Ascension Sacred Heart Pensacola	Level I	Escambia
Baptist Hospital	Level II	Escambia
Broward Health Medical Center	Level I	Broward
Broward Health North	Level II	Broward
Delray Medical Center	Level I	Palm Beach
Gulf Coast Medical Center	Level II	Lee
Halifax Health Medical Center of Daytona Beach	Level II	Volusia
HCA Florida Aventura Hospital	Level II	Miami-Dade
HCA Florida Bayonet Point Hospital	Level II	Pasco
HCA Florida Blake Hospital	Level II	Manatee
HCA Florida Fort Walton-Destin Hospital	Level II	Okaloosa
HCA Florida Kendall Hospital	Level I	Miami-Dade
HCA Florida Lake Monroe Hospital	Level II	Seminole
HCA Florida Lawnwood Hospital	Level II	St. Lucie
HCA Florida Memorial Hospital	Level II	Duval
HCA Florida Ocala Hospital	Level II	Marion
HCA Florida Orange Park Hospital	Level II	Clay
HCA Florida Osceola Hospital	Level II	Osceola
Holmes Regional Medical Center	Level II	Brevard
Jackson Memorial Hospital	Level I	Miami-Dade
Jackson South Medical Center	Level II	Miami-Dade
Johns Hopkins All Children's Hospital	Pediatric	Pinellas
Lakeland Regional Health Medical Center	Provisional Level I	Polk
Memorial Regional Hospital	Level I	Broward
Nicklaus Children's Hospital	Pediatric	Miami-Dade
Orlando Health Bayfront Hospital	Level II	Pinellas
Orlando Health Orlando Regional Medical Center	Level I	Orange
Sarasota Memorial Hospital	Level II	Sarasota
St. Joseph's Hospital	Level II / Pediatric	Hillsborough
St. Mary's Medical Center	Level I	Palm Beach
Tallahassee Memorial Hospital	Level II	Leon
Tampa General Hospital	Level I	Hillsborough
UF Health Jacksonville	Level I	Duval
UF Health Shands Hospital	Level I	Alachua
Wolfson Children's Hospital	Pediatric	Duval

V. DOCUMENTATION

- a. EMS Charts

VI. REFERENCES:

- a. Fabian, T.C., Davis, K.A., Gavant, M.L., et al. (1998). Prospective study of blunt aortic injury: helical CT is diagnostic and antihypertensive therapy reduces rupture. *Ann Surg*, 277, 666.